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Purpose

This guide provides the standards for creating, configuring, and moderating the [redacted] Knowledge Network in Microsoft Teams to ensure communities remain organized, collaborative, and aligned with their intended purpose.

Community Structure

For the pilot implementation, the community consists of the following channels:

Channel	Purpose	Posting Style
Rules & Reminders	Communicate community guidelines, announcements, and reminders.	Forum (Moderator-only posts)
Best Practices	Encourage employees to ask questions, share knowledge, and collaborate on professional topics.	Threads

Additional channels may be introduced as the Knowledge Network expands.

Channel Configuration

- **Forum Channel**
  - New posts may only be created by either the team owner or a moderator.
  - Posts should remain concise and easy to reference.
  - Posts in this channel may include:
    - Community Guidelines
    - Posting Etiquette
    - Newly Published Knowledge Articles (Notification)
    - Other Important Announcements
- **Thread Channel**
  - Members may create new discussion threads and collaborate by replying within the appropriate thread.
  - Each thread should focus on a single topic to keep discussions organized and easy to search.
  - Replies should remain relevant to the original discussion and avoid branching into unrelated topics.

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Roles and Responsibilities

Team Owner

Responsible for:

- Creating the Team
- Managing permissions
- Assigning moderators
- Maintaining channel structure
- Collaborating with Moderators for overall governance

Community Moderator

Responsible for:

- Monitoring discussions
- Ensuring conversations remain professional
- Redirecting team members to existing threads if they ask similar questions
- Moving or closing discussions when appropriate
- Escalating unresolved concerns
- Checking for out-of-scope inquiries

SMEs

Responsible for:

- Providing guidance and expertise within their area of specialization.
- Responding to questions that require specialized knowledge or experience.
- Reviewing and validating information identified for inclusion in the knowledge repository.
- Supporting Community Moderators in addressing complex or unresolved discussions.

Team Members

Members are expected to:

- Search before posting
- Remain respectful and follow the community guidelines and posting etiquettes
- Keep discussions on topic
- Avoid posting confidential information
- Continue conversations within the original thread

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Creating a Discussion Thread

To keep discussions organized, every new topic should follow a consistent format.

- **Title**
  Use a short, descriptive title.
- **Background**
  Provide a brief overview of your situation.
- **My Question**
  What advice or recommendations are you seeking?
- **Additional Information/What I've Already Tried**
  Include any relevant context that may help others provide guidance or mention any documentation you've already reviewed.

Unanswered Questions

If a thread remains unanswered after the agreed response period (e.g., **2 business days**):

1. The member may tag the Community Moderator.
2. The Community Moderator reviews the request.
3. If necessary, the Moderator tags the appropriate Subject Matter Expert (SME).
4. If the request falls outside the community's scope, the member is directed to the appropriate department or existing business process.

Knowledge Capture

Moderators should periodically review discussions for content that could benefit the wider organization.

When a discussion contains valuable and broadly applicable guidance:

1. Flag the discussion.
2. Request validation from the appropriate SME or process owner.
3. Convert the validated information into a knowledge article or FAQ.
4. Publish it in the centralized knowledge repository (future phase).

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